

ARKHAM HORROR[®]

THE CARD GAME

The Still Hour Campaign Guide

A campaign for 1–4 investigators, best with 3.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is read as you play. **Do not read ahead.** It tells you when to read each section: the Prologue first, then the loop, then the districts as you reach them. Story text in boxes is read aloud. Everything after a "**Do not read until...**" line stays unread until the guide sends you there: it always starts on a fresh page, so you never glimpse it by accident. Use the contents on this page to find a section.

Some scenario boxes also hold story and resolution cards (First Dark, The Last Hour's resolutions and others) for reading at the table. This guide prints the same text; if they ever differ, the guide governs.

The guide will ask you to **make choices**; **The Districts** says how to record them. Every one returns later in the story.

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New Rules

Read this aloud before the Prologue. It is the whole idea in plain terms. **Campaign Rules**, after it, is a reference: check it when a question comes up, do not read it through. Everything else works as in the Arkham Horror: The Card Game Rules Reference. Numbers are for three investigators; **Difficulty and Player Count** gives the others, and the Control token applies them.

One night, played again and again. You play the Prologue once, then the same night over and over. Each play-through is a **loop**. When a loop ends the board is cleared and it is eleven o'clock in the Square again. Three things carry over: your **Campaign Log**, your shared **banked Memory** and each investigator's **Years**.

The Hourglass is the clock. The agenda deck is nine **Hours**. Each Mythos phase from the second round places 1 doom on the current Hour, so an Hour passes about every second round. When the ninth Hour arrives, the loop ends. Each time an Hour passes, each investigator heals 1 damage and 1 horror.

The town is split into districts. The Square is always in play. Each loop you choose which other districts to visit and lay them out from their boxes. Crossing between districts costs time: the first crossing along each connection each round places 1 doom on the current Hour. You will usually finish work in two or three districts, so choosing where to go is your biggest decision. Each district has an act deck: a first objective you can finish from the start, and a second, deeper one that opens in Part II.

Dissonance is how much the night has noticed you. It is one shared number from 0 to 24 that changes only when an effect says so. Each loop starts it at the number of loops you have completed, up to 6.

Band	Dissonance	What changes
Calm	0–7	Echo enemies are Sleepwalking (harmless).
Glitch	8–15	1 Static token joins the chaos bag. Echoes wake. The Appointed draws closer.
Noticed	16–23	2 Static tokens. The Appointed arrives. Each investigator ages 1 extra Year at the reset.
Reset	24	The loop ends at once.

The **Static token** is a new chaos token: **–3, and raise Dissonance by 1.**

The Appointed cannot be defeated, only held back. It climbs toward you as Dissonance and the Hours rise, and it hunts

whoever carries the most Memory on their cards. An investigator at its location can **Hold Back** it: a success pushes it back a stage and rewinds the Hourglass by 1 Hour (at most 3 times a loop).

Memory is your experience. During a loop you gain Memory tokens on your cards. At the reset they go into one shared pool, **banked Memory**, which you spend between loops on **Recollections** (cards that remember the loop) and upgrades. Carrying Memory also makes you the one being hunted.

Years are the price. No one suffers trauma or dies. Each reset, each investigator gains **1 Year**, and more if they were defeated, if the loop ended in the Noticed band, or if they leaned heavily on the loop's powers. Years move you through four age brackets, each with a small change to your skills. At **18 Years** an investigator ages out.

Knowledge is what you learn. Finishing a district's act records **Knowledge** in your Campaign Log. It changes the town for good and pays banked Memory. Three surface entries, or Loop 3, begins **Part II**. The right deep entries open the way to end the night: **The Last Hour**.

The Control token keeps the numbers. Click it when this guide says to. Your **Campaign Log** keeps the choices you make. If anything is unclear, this guide wins.

Campaign Rules

This section is a reference. Look a rule up when a question comes up; you do not need to read it through before playing (**New Rules** is enough to start). These rules add to the Arkham Horror: The Card Game Rules Reference. Where they disagree with it, these rules win. Numbers are for **three investigators**; **Difficulty and Player Count** gives the other values, and the Control token applies them for you.

Loops. A loop is one play of the night, from Loop Setup until the loop ends. A loop ends at once when the Hourglass reaches **Hour IX** (unless you begin the finale instead; see **The Last Hour**), when every investigator has been defeated or has resigned, or when Dissonance reaches the **reset value** (24). For card text, "scenario" and "game" mean the current loop, and "interlude" means **Between Loops**. The Prologue is not a loop, but during the Prologue, "loop" on a card means the Prologue.

Limits. "Limit once per loop" and "Max once per loop" last until the loop ends. As in the Rules Reference, a limit applies to each investigator separately unless it says "group limit", and "Max" counts every copy of that card, for all investigators.

The reset. When a loop ends, read its resolutions, then **Between Loops**. The board is cleared: every card the boxes laid out, and every token on those cards, leaves the table, and every Static token leaves the chaos bag; then the scar's band puts back its own (see **Dissonance**). The Hourglass returns to Hour I, the Appointed returns to Unseen, and Dissonance restarts at the **scar**: the number of loops completed so far, maximum 6 at three investigators (see **Difficulty and Player Count**). Banked Memory, the Campaign Log and Years carry forward. Within a loop nothing resets: damage, horror, resources and cards in play stay as they are when you travel between districts.

Defeat. Investigators do not suffer trauma in The Still Hour and are never killed. A defeated investigator is eliminated for the rest of the loop, as the Rules Reference describes; Memory on their cards is still banked at the reset (the Control token keeps their count

even though their cards leave play). Defeat costs Years instead (see **Years**). An investigator leaves the campaign only by aging out, or in the finale.

Resigning. The Square (the hub) has "➤: Resign." Resigning eliminates you for the rest of the loop, as the Rules Reference describes, but it is not a defeat: you gain no Year for being defeated, and the Memory on your cards is still banked at the reset. Only the hub Square has this ability, so there is no resigning in the Prologue or the finale. **Ending a night early.** A night does not end when its acts are done: without Resign it runs to Hour IX. Plan on one or two acts a night; once yours are done, every investigator can resign at the Square and the loop ends at once (Loop Resolution 3). Each investigator still gains the usual reset Years (see **Years**). Resign only when you are finished: you cannot return to the night.

Story assets. Some objectives ask you to take control of a set-aside **story asset** (an asset with an encounter-card back) with an ➤ on the act, and bring it to another location. A story asset has no cost and no slot. You cannot discard it or give it to another investigator. When its controller is eliminated (defeated or resigned), it is placed at their location instead of leaving the game, and any investigator there may take control of it with the ➤ on its card. When its act advances, it leaves the game. When the finale begins, set aside each story asset in play or at a location. At the reset it returns to its box.

Parts of the campaign. The campaign has three parts. They are not act cards.

- **Part I — Learning the Rules.** Only each district's first objective (act 1a) can be completed.
- **Part II — The Shape of the Hour.** It begins at **Between Loops** step 5. Each district's second objective (act 2a) opens, the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.
- **The Last Hour.** The finale, once your Campaign Log records **The Way the Night Breaks**.

The Hourglass. The Hours (I–IX) are the agenda deck: "the Hourglass" is that deck, and the current Hour is the current agenda. Hour I has a doom threshold of 3 and Hours II–VIII of 2. From the second round on, the Mythos phase places 1 doom on the current Hour (step 1.2) and then checks its threshold (step 1.3): when the doom in play (on the current Hour and on any other card, as the Rules Reference counts it) meets the current Hour's threshold, the Hourglass advances 1 Hour.

- **Place X doom on the current Hour** (district crossings and small costs of time) puts doom tokens on the current Hour; its threshold is checked only in the Mythos phase, as in the Rules Reference. When the Hourglass advances or rewinds for any reason, remove all doom in play.
- **The Hour turns.** Each time the Hourglass advances to a new Hour (by doom or by a Skip, not when an advance is canceled), each investigator heals 1 damage and 1 horror.
- **Advance the Hourglass by X Hours** (a **Skip**) advances the agenda at once, one Hour at a time: remove all doom in play, turn the current Hour over and read its back, then make the next Hour the current agenda. Set each advanced Hour aside, in order, beside the Hours deck instead of removing it from the game. The Hourglass never advances past Hour IX. Any effect that advances the Hourglass is a Skip.
- **An Hour's Forced ability.** Hours II–IX each have "Forced — When the Hourglass advances to this Hour:". It resolves each

time that Hour becomes the current agenda by advancing (by doom or by a Skip). A Skip of several Hours resolves each Hour's ability in order. If the Hourglass advances to an Hour again after a rewind, its ability resolves again.

- **Rewind the Hourglass by X Hours:** X times, put the current Hour back on top of the Hours deck and make the last Hour you set aside the current agenda again, with no doom on it. Rewinding never resolves an Hour's Forced ability and does not end effects an Hour already created. The Hourglass never rewinds before Hour I.
- **Cancel an advance:** cancel all of it, however many Hours it would advance. The current Hour stays current; remove all doom from it.

Districts and travel. Ambergrove has six **districts**; each is a cluster of locations laid out from its own box, and every location belongs to one district. **The Square** is the hub. The district connections are The Square–The Nave, The Square–The Milestones, The Square–The Ticket Booth and The Square–The Reading Room. The first time in a round that any investigator moves along a given district connection (in either direction, by any means), place 1 doom on the current Hour after that move. Other investigators may move along that same connection later in the round without placing more. A move that is not along a connection, or that says it does not place doom, costs no time, and it does not count as the first move along that connection this round. Enemy moves never cost time. You will reach only two or three districts before time runs out. Connection symbols match by shape **and** color: some shapes repeat in other districts in a different color, and a location connects only to locations whose symbol matches both. The district connections listed here, and The Turning–The Winding Stair, are the only connections between districts. The Turning–The Winding Stair is not a district connection: the Lighthouse stands at the end of the Sunken Road, and moving between them never places doom. (A **crossing** is always a move along a district connection. *The Crossing*, an encounter card of the Square, only shares the word: it is a card with its own text.)

Dissonance. A shared value from 0 to the reset value (24). Apart from Loop Setup, where it is set to the scar, it changes only when an effect says to **raise** or **lower** it. Dissonance sets the band:

Band	Dissonance	While in this band	On entering this band
Calm	0–7	No band Static tokens. Echoes are Sleepwalking.	—
Glitch	8–15	1 band Static token in the chaos bag.	The Appointed's Approach advances to at least Sensed.
Noticed	16–23	2 band Static tokens in the chaos bag.	The Appointed's Approach advances to Arrived.
Reset	24	—	The loop ends at once, even during a skill test or the finale.

A band change takes effect at once. Static tokens added by cards are in addition to the band's. Lowering Dissonance never pushes the Approach back. Setting Dissonance at Loop Setup does not count as entering a band.

The Static token. A chaos token and a symbol token: **–3. Raise Dissonance by 1.** Like the other symbol effects, this resolves when the token is revealed during a skill test; the token returns to the bag afterward. A canceled Static token has no modifier and no effect. A sealed Static token still counts toward its band's number.

Number and symbol tokens. A number token is a chaos token that shows only a modifier (+1, 0, –1 and so on). Every other chaos token (♣, ♠, ♥, ♦, ☆, ★ and the Static token) is a symbol token.

Echoes and Sleepwalking. An Echo is an enemy with the Echo trait. **Sleepwalking** is a keyword: while an enemy is Sleepwalking, it cannot engage or be engaged, attack, or move, and it cannot be attacked, evaded, dealt damage or chosen as the target of a card ability. It is still an enemy in play at its location. A Sleepwalking enemy that would spawn engaged with an investigator spawns unengaged at that investigator's location instead; an engaged enemy that becomes Sleepwalking disengages and stays where it is. Every Echo has the Sleepwalking keyword printed on it; that keyword applies only while Dissonance is in the Calm band, unless a card says otherwise. It **wakes** when it stops being Sleepwalking, and it can fall asleep again. An Echo that wakes is **exhausted** (it readies in the upkeep phase as usual), so it engages no one until then.

The Appointed. Something called the Appointed climbs an **Approach**: Unseen, Sensed, Emerging, Arrived. To **advance** the Approach (to a stage) means to raise it, never lower it; to **push it back** means to lower it by 1 stage, never below Unseen. When the Approach becomes Sensed or later while the Appointed is set aside, it **manifests**: put it into play at the revealed location farthest from all investigators that is not closed (the lead investigator breaks ties). When the Approach is pushed back to Unseen, set the Appointed aside. It cannot be defeated. **Hold Back** is an ➤ on its card that only an investigator at its location can take, and only while the Appointed is ready; a success exhausts it, so the Appointed can be held back at most once per round. A "Hold Back success" means succeeding at its test, or resolving it without a test when a card allows. Its behavior at each stage is on **The Appointed's Approach**, which is in play beside the Hours deck during every loop and the finale.

Memory.

- **Memory on cards** is Memory tokens on investigator and asset cards you control. "Most Memory" in a prey or spawn instruction means Memory on cards. Charges on Stolen Minute are not Memory.
- **Banked Memory** is one pool the whole party shares. "Each investigator gains X banked Memory" adds X to the pool per investigator. Banked Memory never drops below 0: an effect that would remove more removes all of it.
- At the reset, all Memory on cards (including the cards of defeated investigators) is banked. Between loops you spend banked Memory as experience (Rules Reference, "Experience"), with these exceptions:
 - A **Recollection** costs its printed Memory cost and nothing more. It is itself a level 0 card, so it does not also pay the 1 Memory of a new level 0 card.
 - An **upgrade** costs Memory equal to the **new** card's level, with **no credit for the card it replaces**. (The Rules Reference has you pay the difference; this campaign does not.) Going straight to the level you want is therefore cheaper than climbing: level 0 to 2 to 4 costs 2 + 4 = 6 Memory, and level 0 straight to 4 costs 4.

- Any other **new level 0 card** costs 1.
- Each copy is bought, and paid for, separately.
- Decks keep their deck size. An upgrade replaces its base copy. Any other card you buy (a Recollection or a new level 0 card) takes the place of a different card, which you remove from the deck. Permanent cards, such as Anchor Point, do not count toward deck size, so buying one removes nothing.
- Banked Memory is one shared pool. How it is divided between the investigators' purchases is the table's choice.
- After spending, if banked Memory is above **10 per investigator** (30 at three), reduce it to that number.
- A starting deck holds level 0 cards only, and no Recollections: they are bought between loops. (Signature Recollections are the exception.) The Recollection cards are in the **Player Cards** bag that the campaign box's **Place** laid out, two copies of each (the most one deck may hold); take each copy you buy from it. If another investigator needs a copy, copy one in Tabletop Simulator: hover over the card, press **Ctrl+C**, then **Ctrl+V**. The ten, with their Memory costs:

Recollection	Card type	Memory
Foreknowledge	Skill	2
Muscle Memory	Skill	2
The Same Doorway Twice	Event	2
Rehearsed Escape	Event	2
The Long Way Round	Event	2
This Time For Sure	Event	2
Stolen Minute	Asset	3
Cassandra's Notebook	Asset	3
Anchor Point	Asset (permanent)	4
The Hour I Learned Your Name	Event	5

- The campaign does not change the taboo list: use the current Arkham Horror taboo list.
- Investigators never earn experience in this campaign; banked Memory replaces it, and Victory pays as **Victory** describes. Anything that changes an experience cost changes the Memory cost the same way: an exceptional card costs twice, a myriad card's extra copies are free, each customizable checkbox costs 1 Memory, and taboo changes apply.

Experience cards. Cards that gain or earn experience (Ascetic, In the Thick of It, The Great Work, Charon's Obol and the like) do nothing in this campaign, because investigators never earn experience; leave them out of your deck. Cards that change an experience cost change the Memory cost instead, as above.

Exile. A card that is exiled leaves your deck until you buy it again between loops, at its normal Memory cost.

Trauma and defeat. A card that would give you trauma gives you none, and the rest of its text works as printed (see **Defeat**). A card that defeats you, or is priced in being defeated, works as printed, and you are defeated as normal.

Records from other campaigns. A card that needs a Campaign Log record from another campaign (Researched cards, and the Untranslated and Unidentified cards that write those records) cannot be used in this campaign; leave it out of your deck.

Knowledge. Completing a district's objectives records **Knowledge** entries in your Campaign Log. An entry belongs to the whole party and changes the night from then on; its lasting effect is printed on the Campaign Log beside it. Entries from acts 1a are **surface** entries; entries from acts 2a are **deep** entries. Knowledge is never bought, only found. "Your Campaign Log records X" means X is written on the log; "you completed <act> this loop" means that act advanced during the loop.

- **Knowledge pays Memory.** The first time your Campaign Log records an entry, each investigator gains banked Memory: **1 for a surface entry** and **3 for a deep entry**. The Prologue's entry and The Way the Night Breaks pay nothing. An entry pays once per campaign, and the investigator count is the count when it is recorded.
- **Threads.** The Campaign Log also tracks **Seraphine's thread**: unheard, suspected or known. It starts unheard; cards tell you when to mark it. It has no rules effect; it changes one line of the epilogue.
- **The Way the Night Breaks.** This entry is not found at a district: it is recorded together with The Appointed's Name, whose act can be completed only once your log records What the Almanac Hid and The Vote That Never Ends. If either of those two entries is unticked, untick this one too. The Control token does this for you and tells you when to record it.

Years. At each reset, each investigator gains **Years**: 1 always; 1 more if they were defeated during the loop; 1 more if the loop ended in the Noticed band or higher (16+); and 1 more if they **leaned on the loop** (during the loop, they paid "raise Dissonance" as a cost 3 or more times, or removed 4 or more Memory from their own cards, as a cost or by their own choice, for their own cards and abilities, such as Foreknowledge). Years that a card or resolution gives (A Year in a Night, the Hall of Mirrors, the ninth line, the name) are recorded when gained with the **Years pending** button on that investigator's card, and added at Between Loops step 1 with the reset Years. The Records Office can take back one Year a card gave during the current loop. Years set an investigator's age bracket, and a higher bracket replaces the lower. Bracket changes apply only Between Loops. Skills and maximum health and sanity never drop below 1.

- **Prime (0–4 Years):** no change.
- **Weathered (5–9):** the first time an investigator reaches Weathered or a later bracket, choose and record **–1** ☹ or **–1** 🐼, and **+1** 🐼 or **+1** 🐼. These choices are locked (the Control token's **Aging** says how to enter them).
- **Elder (10–14):** the Weathered changes, **+1** more to the same mental skill, **–1** maximum health, and they begin each loop with 1 Memory on their investigator card.
- **Ancient (15+):** the Elder changes and **–1** maximum sanity.
- An investigator whose Years reach **18** at **Between Loops** step 1 ages out at once and does not play the next loop. The first time an investigator ages out, add 1 🐼 token to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign. Their player may begin the next loop with a new investigator not yet used in this campaign (0 Years, a new deck of level 0 cards, no Recollections), or the party continues without them: set **Investigators** on the Control token to the new number. A new investigator may receive purchases from banked Memory from the next **Between Loops**, like anyone else. If no investigator can continue, the campaign ends; see **Age stories**.

For finale conditions and the epilogue, an investigator's bracket is set by all their Years, including Years gained during that loop and the finale.

Victory. Each **Victory X** pays once per campaign. When you defeat an enemy with Victory X (a **Named** enemy, which some districts add from Part II, or one of a few optional monsters), or when a loop ends with a Victory X location in play, revealed and with no clues on it: if its name is not on your Campaign Log's Victory list, record it and each investigator gains X banked Memory. An enemy with Victory X can be met again in a later loop, but only the first defeat pays. An enemy that a district's act 2a spawns appears only while that act is the district's current act: once the district's deep entry is recorded, its act deck is removed and the enemy does not return, so defeat it before you complete that act if you want its Victory. A defeated enemy with Victory X goes to the victory display for the rest of the loop.

Campaign chaos-bag changes. Some story results add or remove a ,  or  token for the rest of the campaign, on top of your difficulty's tokens; the text that causes one says so. Remove a token only if one is in the chaos bag. If you set the difficulty with the Control token's buttons, it makes every change for you and tells you in the chat; otherwise make each change by hand and note it on your Campaign Log. Three are public:

- Part II begins: add 1 .
- The first time a loop is marked **Torn**: add 1 .
- The first time an investigator ages out: add 1 .

Locations trade one thing for another. Many locations have an ability that lets you pay in one currency (time, Dissonance, a clue, a Year) to gain another. A few have a hazard that stops once your Campaign Log records that district's Knowledge.

Revealed locations. A location that enters play revealed, or is revealed by an effect (a closed location opening, the Belfry at Hour III), has clues placed on it equal to its clue value at that moment, unless the effect says not to add clues. Flipping a location to its other side (for example its calm side) never adds clues.

Closed and impassable locations. A **closed** location is unrevealed, has no clues and is not connected to anything: investigators and enemies cannot move into it, and nothing spawns or manifests there. When it opens, it is revealed: place its clues on it. (The Rules Reference's "seal" is only for chaos tokens; the location called The Sealed Study keeps its name.) Investigators and enemies cannot move into an **impassable** location; anything already there stays unless it is told to move.

The Control token. The Control token keeps the campaign's books. Use it like this, and do not also apply by hand what it applies for you:

- **Hour.** Put doom tokens on the current Hour as the Mythos phase and cards place them (the Control token does not count doom). Each time the Hourglass advances or rewinds, move the Hours deck to match and click **Hour** once per Hour (left-click advance, right-click rewind). With SCED, **Hour** also removes all doom in play for you (SCED's own doom reset: the doom counter goes to 0 and the doom tokens leave the playmats and the play area); take any doom tokens off the Hours cards yourself, and remove all doom in play yourself if you play without SCED. On an advance it applies Hour III's base +1 Dissonance, the Approach at Hours V, VII and VIII, Hour VI's Static token and Hour VIII's +2 Dissonance. Resolve the rest yourself: the 1 damage and 1 horror each investigator heals

when an Hour passes, Hour II's encounter draws, Hour III's extra +1 at a Church location (click Dissonance) and revealing The Belfry, Hour IV, Hour VII's exhaust, Hour VIII's +1 fight and Hour IX. (Exception: **Hold Back** on the Appointed's card rewinds the Hour counter itself; move the Hours deck, but do not also right-click **Hour**.)

- **Canceled effects.** If an effect the Control token already applied is canceled (for example an Hour's Forced ability canceled by It Means 'Wait'), undo it with the matching button: right-click **Dissonance** for Dissonance it added, right-click the **[static]** button for a Static token, and click **Appointed** back if the Approach moved. Exactly: a canceled Hour III, right-click **Dissonance** once; Hour V, right-click **Appointed** once if it moved; Hour VII, right-click **Appointed** once per stage it advanced; Hour VIII, right-click **Dissonance** twice and **Appointed** once per stage it advanced (and take the +1 fight off each enemy yourself). If Dissonance falls back into Calm, the chat tells you the Echoes fall asleep again. If Hour VI is canceled, click **Undo Hour VI** instead (it appears once Hour VI has resolved this loop): it takes back Hour VI's change to the chaos bag, and Hour VI resolves again if it is reached again this loop.
- **Dissonance.** Each time a card or ability raises or lowers Dissonance, click **Dissonance** (left-click +1, right-click -1). It applies the band's Static tokens and Approach for you. A Static token drawn from the chaos bag waits for your decision: after cancellation choices, if it resolves in a skill test, left-click **Resolve** on that token before continuing the test (or **Static waiting** on the Control when only one token is pending); the Control token applies its +1 Dissonance and consequences. Do not also click **Dissonance**. For a canceled token or an outside-test preview (for example Marked Deck), return it to the bag or right-click **Resolve** on that token; neither changes campaign state. With multiple pending tokens, use their individual buttons; the Control button refuses an ambiguous choice. When a sealed Static token is later treated as the revealed token (Marked Deck), left-click **Dissonance** yourself only if it resolves.
- **Temporary Static tokens.** When a card adds a Static token for a limited time, left-click the **[static]** button; when that time ends, or the Press removes it, right-click it. (Hour VI's change is applied by **Hour**; see **Canceled effects** to undo it.)
- **Leaning on the loop.** Each time an investigator pays "raise Dissonance" as a cost or additional cost, click **Dissonance raised** on their investigator card (as well as **Dissonance**). Each time they remove Memory from their own cards for their own cards or abilities (for example Foreknowledge), click **Loop-power Memory** once per Memory. The Interlude's **Age** button reads these. Click **Dissonance raised** once per payment, however much it raises (The Turning is one click here and two on **Dissonance**).
- **Years pending.** When a card or resolution gives an investigator Years, click **Years pending** on their investigator card; **Age** adds them. When the Records Office takes one back, right-click it.
- **Memory on cards.** Click an investigator's **Memory** row when Memory is placed on or removed from their cards (left-click +1, right-click -1).
- **The Appointed.** When The Crossing, The Debt of Hours or the finale advances the Approach, click **Appointed** once per stage. After a Hold Back success (including the walker's ring and The Hour I Learned Your Name), click **Hold Back** on its card once: it

pushes the Approach back 1 stage and rewinds the Hour counter by 1 for you. Disengage and exhaust the card yourself. When an effect pushes the Approach back further (The Hour I Learned Your Name's additional stage), right-click **Appointed** once per extra stage. While it hunts, click **Hunt** once in each enemy phase while it is ready and unengaged. On a farthest-location tie, the Control token names the tied destinations and makes a default placement; the lead investigator chooses and moves it to another tied destination before continuing if needed. If the Control token places it on a closed or unrevealed location, move it to the location the rules require.

- **Personal quest cards.** Each investigator starts with one **Permanent** quest card (see **Campaign Setup**). Its front names a quest and a **tally** you keep across the whole campaign: left-click the **Quest** button on your investigator card to add 1 (right-click takes 1 back); the Campaign Log's **Quest** counter on your panel shows it too. When the tally reaches the goal, the Control token tells you: **swap** the quest card for its bonded unlocked card (take it from the **Player Cards** bag) and tick **met** on your Campaign Log panel. The unlocked card carries what ties your investigator to this campaign, such as the **Memory** they place on themselves, and a few clauses that reach into the campaign's own trackers (Dissonance, the Hourglass, Knowledge). Until you swap the card, none of that applies to you. Your investigator card, signature cards and weaknesses never need the campaign's trackers.
- **Knowledge and Victory.** When you record a Knowledge entry or a Victory, tick it on the Campaign Log token. The Control token then applies what it changes (location sides, and the Memory it pays, each the first time only). If you tick a Knowledge box by mistake, untick it: the entry is removed and the Memory it paid is taken back, as far as banked Memory allows (ticking it again pays back only what was taken).
- **Contest.** In the finale, the Control token shows a **Contest** counter (left-click +1, right-click -1). No contest progress is automatic: click **Contest** for every source listed under **Contest progress**, including each Hold Back success and the Uninvited's defeat.
- **Aging.** After the Prologue there is no aging: the buttons read **No Age**. After a loop, in the Interlude panel, set each investigator's **Defeated** toggle, and the first time they will reach Weathered, their -skill and +skill buttons. If you click **Age** for such an investigator before choosing, the Control token asks you to choose and applies nothing; click **Age** again to apply. The chat then names the skills changed (for example, "-1 combat, +1 willpower").
- **Memory.** **Begin Next Loop** adds the 1 Memory an Elder or Ancient investigator begins with to their count; put the token on their investigator card at Loop Setup step 7, and do not click their Memory row for it. **Anchor Point's** Memory is not added for you: at Loop Setup step 7, put its token on the investigator card and click their **Memory** row once for it (an Elder or Ancient investigator with Anchor Point clicks once, for Anchor Point only). Click the banked **Memory** button when banked Memory changes outside the Interlude panel (The House Always Wins, a finale resolution that spends it, and the party's extra 1 in the first Prologue ending). It never goes below 0. For the Prologue's reward, click **Prologue reward** once: it banks 2 per investigator (right-click takes it back).

- **Between loops.** Use **Reset Loop**, **Interlude**, **Begin Next Loop** and **Clear Board** as **Between Loops** and **Loop Setup** direct. **Reset Loop** counts once per loop: a second click before **Begin Next Loop** does nothing. If it says the loop is not over by the Control token's count (the Hourglass is not at Hour IX and Dissonance is below the reset value: for example every investigator was defeated or resigned, or the Prologue ended by its act), click **Reset Loop** again to end it. **Begin Next Loop** refuses until **Reset Loop** has been clicked, and after **Reset Loop** the Control token reads **BETWEEN LOOPS**.
- **Other buttons.** **Status** prints the current Hour, Dissonance, band, scar, Memory and Part to the chat. **Knowledge** lists the entries recorded so far. **Sync Board** re-applies the board from the campaign state (location sides and CLOSED labels, the Appointed's position and the chaos bag's Static tokens); use it if the table and the Control token disagree. Right-click the Control token for **Guide: Campaign Setup, The Prologue, Loop Setup, Between Loops, Campaign Rules, Difficulty and Player Count** and **Starting Decks**: each turns the campaign guide to that section.

Difficulty and Player Count

- **3 investigators:** every value as printed (Dissonance bands at 8 / 16, reset at 24, Memory cap 30, scar cap 6).
- **2 or 4 investigators:** the reset comes at $8 \times \text{investigators}$; the Glitch band starts at one-third of the reset and the Noticed band at two-thirds (rounded down: 5 / 10 at two, 10 / 21 at four). The Memory cap is $10 \times \text{investigators}$, and the scar cap is $2 \times \text{investigators}$. With **2 investigators**, each gets **+2 maximum health** and **+2 maximum sanity** (the Control token shows them).
- **1 investigator:** use the two-investigator bands: the reset comes at **16**, the Noticed band at **10** and Glitch at **5**; the scar cap is **4**. The Memory cap is **10**. Your investigator gets **+3 maximum health** and **+3 maximum sanity** (the Control token shows the new maximums on their card). **Second wind:** once each loop (and once in the finale), when your investigator would be defeated, they are not: remove all damage and horror from them, and they gain **1 Year** (click **Years pending**).
- The finale's contest is **6** at 2 or 3 investigators, **5** with one and **7** with four: its sources barely grow with the party, but four investigators get more tries at Hold Back each round.
- Values given "per investigator" (the finale's Memory thresholds) scale on their own.
- The Control token applies all of these for you.
- The campaign is tuned for about 6–8 loops.

Campaign Setup

1. **Choose investigators.** The campaign is tuned for 3; it scales from 1 to 4.
2. **Build decks.** Each investigator builds a deck under their deckbuilding rules, adding 1 random basic weakness as normal. Build a **starting deck of level 0 cards only**: Recollections and upgrades are bought later, between loops. If you would like a ready-made list, **Appendix — Starting Decks** suggests one for each investigator.
3. **Put the investigators on the table.** The campaign box's **Place** laid out the **Player Cards** bag. Each player takes their investigator card from it, along with the signature and other required cards listed on the back of that card (they do not count toward deck size; one of them is the investigator's **personal quest card**, see below), and the cards of their deck, and puts the investigator card on a playmat. The Control token's per-investigator rows (Memory, Age) and the buttons on each investigator card (including **Quest**) appear once the investigator cards are on the table, on their playmats.
4. **Choose a difficulty** and assemble the chaos bag. On the Control token, click your difficulty's button (**Easy**, **Standard**, **Hard** or **Expert**): it fills SCED's chaos bag with the tokens below, plus any campaign chaos-bag changes so far (see **Campaign chaos-bag changes**). Without SCED, build the bag by hand. Then set **Investigators** on the Control token to the number of investigators.

Difficulty	Chaos tokens
Easy	+1, +1, 0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2,  ,   ,  ,  ,  , 
Standard	+1, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -4,  ,   ,  ,  ,  , 
Hard	0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -5,   ,  ,  ,  , 
Expert	0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -4, -5, -6, -8,  ,  ,  ,  , 

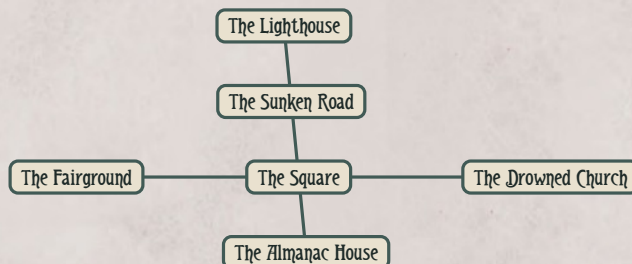
Use the scenario reference card's Easy / Standard side for Easy and Standard, and its Hard / Expert side for Hard and Expert.

5. **Take the Campaign Log** (the log token, or the pages at the back of this guide). The log token has three pages: page 1 holds the investigators, the loop counter and banked Memory; page 2 the Knowledge Track, Victory and threads; page 3 those who left the loop, your choices and the finale record. To turn the page, right-click the token and choose **Next page**. A choice is a row with two boxes, in the order the guide lists its options: tick the one you took. On page 1, **Fill investigators** copies the investigators' names from the table. Record your investigators and difficulty. The log keeps what you have not yet learned hidden: each Knowledge entry, Named enemy and choice has a row, and its name appears on the token only when you tick it (on the printed pages, write it on the row's line). Each investigator starts at **0 Years**; banked Memory (one shared pool) starts at **0**.
6. Turn to **Prologue — The First Hour**.

Boxes. Every box has **Place** and **Recall**. A district's **Place** takes a few seconds: it lays the cards out one at a time and says in the chat how far it has got. Press it once; while the district is on the table, pressing it again is refused (it would lay a second copy on top of the first). To take a box back (a district placed by mistake, or the end of a loop), press **Recall** on that box; **Clear Board** on the Control token takes back every district at once.

The Ambergrove Map

A small town at the end of a shore road, under a starless, snagged sky. **The Square** is the hub. The first move each round along a connection between two districts places 1 doom on the current Hour (see **Districts and travel**).



- **The Square** connects to the Fairground, the Drowned Church, the Almanac House and the Sunken Road.
- **The Sunken Road** connects the Square to the **Lighthouse**. The road runs on into the Lighthouse: moving between the Turning and the Winding Stair costs no time.
- Each district is a cluster of 2–4 locations. They enter play unrevealed unless their entry says otherwise. As the Rules Reference describes, when an investigator enters an unrevealed location, it is revealed: flip it, and SCED places its clues.

Prologue – The First Hour

Do not read until the end of the scenario.

You are in Ambergrove for your own reasons: a letter, a debt, a promise, a rumor. Soon, you will not remember them.

Ambergrove is a town on no one's way to anywhere: a church, a road out to the shore, a lighthouse no ship has needed in years, a printing house that sells almanacs to three counties. Tonight it is full. The almanac has promised an occultation, a star swallowed by the dark of something passing in front of it, once in a hundred years, and visible from here and nowhere else.

The whole town has turned out for the occultation. Lanterns are strung across the Square. A band is tuning up by the Town Hall steps, and children ride their fathers' shoulders, pointing at a sky that is not quite right.

The almanac promised the occultation at midnight. It is eleven, and the stars are already sliding behind something that has no edge. You will remember everything else.

Setup

1. Press **Place** on **The First Hour** box. It lays out:
 - the **Hours** as the agenda deck, Hour I on top;
 - the act **The First Hour**;
 - **The Still Hour** scenario reference card;
 - the encounter deck, face down. Shuffle it;
 - the story card **The First Reset**, set aside. Read it when the Prologue ends.
2. Put **The Long Pier**, **The Square** and **The Almanac Steps** into play in a row, in that order (Place does this). The Square is revealed; the other two are unrevealed. Each investigator begins at **The Square**.
3. The Control token starts a new campaign in the Prologue, at **Hour I** with Dissonance **0**. The chaos bag is in the Calm band.
4. Each investigator takes 5 resources and draws an opening hand of 5 cards (mulligan as normal). Choose a lead investigator. You are ready to begin.

The objective. The act **The First Hour** can advance only once the Hourglass has reached Hour VIII or later: investigators at The Almanac Steps spend its clues as a group. So the Prologue lasts about eight rounds or more. Each time an investigator enters The Almanac Steps, Dissonance rises by 1 (it is printed on the location), so waiting elsewhere until Hour VIII is cheaper than waiting on the Steps or going back and forth to them.

There is no Appointed in the Prologue, and no Years are gained in it: ignore any text that refers to the Appointed, and A Year in a Night gives no Year. The Prologue ends when The First Hour advances, or the way a loop does: at Hour IX, when every investigator is defeated, or when Dissonance reaches the reset value. Its locations belong to no district, so moving between them never places doom.

Note. The Prologue teaches the loop. It cannot be lost: however it ends, the night resets, and how well you did decides one small reward.

Resolution 1 – You Saw It Coming (you advanced The First Hour)

You were standing on the right step at the right second. You watched the occultation complete, and you watched something reach through, and not finish reaching. When the night folds, you fold with it on purpose, and you keep more of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**, and the party gains **1** more. (Click **Prologue reward** once, then **Memory** once.)

Resolution 2 – It Caught You Unready (the Hourglass reached Hour IX, or Dissonance reached the reset value)

The occultation completes. Something reaches through, and does not finish reaching. The night folds. You are standing in the Square again at eleven o'clock, salt on your tongue, and you are the only ones who feel the seam.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**. (Click **Prologue reward** once.)

No Resolution – The First Death (every investigator was defeated)

The last thing you see is the sky finishing what it started: the final star sliding behind the edgeless dark. There is no pain. There is a long, patient silence, like a held breath. Then a band is tuning up, and the lanterns are being lit, and it is eleven o'clock. You remember dying. You remember all of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**. (Click **Prologue reward** once.)
- This first death is free. None of the others will be.

Whichever ending you read: record **You Are Unstuck** in your Campaign Log (on the log token, also tick that ending in **Prologue ended**). Part I begins. No Years are gained from the Prologue. Then read **What You Saw**.

What You Saw

Salt on your tongue. The same lanterns, the same band, the same children on the same shoulders. You look at one another across the Square and see it in each other's faces: you all remember. No one else does. It does not feel like the first time this night has happened, only the first time you noticed. A woman in a green shawl asks if you are feeling well.

The investigators must decide (choose one):

- **Tell the town.** Stand on the Town Hall steps and tell them what is coming, though they will not believe a word. Record in your Campaign Log: *The town was warned.*
- **Tell no one.** Whatever this is, it is yours to carry, and a secret kept is a card still in the hand. Record in your Campaign Log:

You kept the night to yourselves.

Then, on the Control token, click **Reset Loop** (if it says the loop is not over by its count, click it again). This ends the Prologue; the Prologue does not count as a loop. Turn to **The Loop**, read **Between Loops**, and begin Loop 1.

The Loop

Play every loop from here on the same way: set it up, play the night across the districts you choose, and when it ends read the loop's resolution, then **Between Loops**.

Loop Setup

1. If a loop or the Prologue just ended, click **Clear Board** on the Control token (see **The reset**). Do not use SCED's own **Reset play areas** button (on the Clean Up Helper) for this: it removes every investigator's cards and deck from the table. Each investigator heals all damage and horror, removes all clues, resources and Memory (it was banked Between Loops) from their cards and discards all resources, shuffles every card they own back into their deck except permanent cards and cards their own rules set aside or put into play at the start of a game (such as bonded cards), sets those up as at the start of a game, takes 5 resources and draws an opening hand of 5 cards (mulligan as normal; weaknesses drawn now are set aside and replaced). Then the investigators choose a lead investigator for this loop.
2. Press **Place** on **The Square (Town Hall)** box. It lays out the Square's locations, the **Hours** (agenda deck, Hour I on top), the scenario reference card, the shared encounter deck, the Square's act deck (in the **Act** slot of the mythos area) and, set aside, the Appointed's cards (the Appointed, The Appointed's Approach, its Whispers, and two story cards whose text this guide gives) and the Square's story asset.
3. Note every Knowledge entry on your Campaign Log that changes an Hour (for example, Hour IV's Forced ability no longer resolving). The Hours deck itself never changes.
4. The Control token shows **Hour I** and Dissonance at the **scar** (see **The reset**).
5. **Choose the districts** you mean to visit this loop. For each one, press **Place** on its box. Its locations join the map unrevealed (except any its entry says are revealed), its act deck goes where **The Districts** says, and its encounter set and any Named enemy go face down just below the mythos area. Shuffle each district's encounter set into the encounter deck. Leave each Named enemy set aside unless its district's entry says otherwise. You may also Place another district's box later in the loop, immediately before an investigator moves into it; no investigator can move into a district whose box is not placed.
6. **Part II onward:** shuffle the Appointed's Whispers into the encounter deck.
7. Put **The Appointed's Approach** into play faceup beside the Hours deck; its text is active for the whole loop. The Appointed begins **Unseen**, set aside. Each investigator begins at **The Square**. Each "At the start of each loop" ability (Anchor Point) resolves now: put its Memory token on the investigator card and click their **Memory** row once (the Control token does not add Anchor Point's Memory itself, only the Elder or Ancient start Memory).

8. Read The Square's entry in **The Districts** now. The first time you enter any other district in this loop, read its entry.
9. Apply the **standing rules** of the choices your Campaign Log records. Each shows under its choice on page 3 of the log token once you tick the choice (on the printed pages it was printed with the choice, in the district resolution where you made it, and you write it under the choice).

Salt on your tongue. Lanterns across the Square. A band tuning up. It is eleven o'clock, and you have been here before.

Do not read until the loop ends.

A loop ends the moment one of its endings happens. Before anything else, claim Victory for each Victory X location that qualifies (see **Victory**). Then check the endings **top to bottom** and read the first that happened. Then read the **district resolution** for each district whose box you placed this loop (see **The Districts**), and then **Between Loops**.

Resolution 2 – The Seam Tears (Dissonance reached the reset value)

You leaned on what you remembered until the night could feel the weight. Every clock in Ambergrove stops on the same wrong second. The sky does not fold this time. It splits, and you fall back through the gap to eleven o'clock, bleeding time.

- The loop ended in danger: each investigator's **+1 Year** for ending in the Noticed band or higher applies.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Torn**. If it is the first Torn loop, add 1  token to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign.
- If this is the **second or later** Torn loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *The town has learned your shape. Strangers at the fair stop mid-laugh when you pass, and do not know why.*

No Resolution – The Night Keeps You (every investigator was defeated)

The dark finishes what it started. For a long moment there is nothing: no Square, no bell, no salt. Then the lanterns are being lit again, and you are standing where you always stand, and your hands will not stop shaking.

- Each investigator gains the **+1 Year** for being defeated.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Taken**.
- If this is the **second or later** Taken loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *You have died in this town more times than you can hold in your head at once. Each of you keeps one of those deaths close, like a stone in a pocket, and it is heavier every time.*

Resolution 3 – You Walk Out of the Night (every investigator resigned or was defeated, and at least one resigned)

You leave the Square by the station road while the band is still playing. Behind you the night goes on without you, hour after hour, and at midnight it closes on an empty Square. Then the lanterns are being lit again, and you are standing where you always stand.

- Each defeated investigator gains the **+1 Year** for being defeated; an investigator who resigned does not.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Closed at the Hour**.

Resolution 1 – The Appointed Hour (the Hourglass reached Hour IX)

The occultation completes on time, exactly as the almanac promised. Something reaches through the edgeless dark, and, again, does not finish reaching. The night folds along its old crease. Eleven o'clock. Salt. The lanterns.

- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Closed at the Hour**.
- If you recorded **at least one** new Knowledge entry this loop, add to the interlude story: *Something of the night came loose in your hands. You hold on to that.* If you recorded **none**, add: *Another night spent. The town did not notice you at all, which is its own kind of warning.*

Between Loops

Run this after every reset, and once after the Prologue. First, if you have not already, click **Reset Loop** on the Control token; then click **Interlude** on it for steps 1 to 3.

1. **Age.** (Skip this step after the Prologue: it grants no Years, and Reset Loop discards its Years pending.) Each investigator adds their reset Years for the loop just ended plus their Years pending (see **Years**). Apply any bracket change now, as the Control token's **Aging** describes, then tick the same choices on the Campaign Log. An investigator who reaches 18 Years ages out.
2. **Bank Memory.** On the Interlude panel, click **Bank on-card Memory** once. It moves all Memory on cards (including the cards of investigators defeated this loop) to banked Memory. Memory on the cards of an investigator who aged out at step 1 is lost with them. Then take the Memory tokens off your cards.
3. **Spend.** Spend banked Memory as **Memory** describes (Recollections, upgrades and new level 0 cards; upgraded cards replace their base versions). For a new level 0 card, right-click the banked **Memory** button once. Once your log records The Way the Night Breaks, **Before the finale** says what to keep.
4. **Record.** Update the scar (loops completed, maximum 6 at three investigators), the Knowledge Track, the Victory list and any choices on your Campaign Log, and write any campaign chaos-bag changes under **Campaign notes** (the Control token tracks them for you). Also write each investigator's Years and any Recollections they bought, what you spent this interlude, the current Part, and anyone who aged out under **Those Who Left the Loop** (on the log token, right-click it and choose **Sync from campaign** to fill the numbers the Control token tracks; the printed pages need them written). (Knowledge entries are ticked when their acts say so. If you tick one now, do it before **Begin Next Loop**.)
5. **Check the Part.** If Part II has not begun, and your log now records **3 or more** surface Knowledge entries or you have completed **Loop 3**, Part II begins (see **Parts of the campaign**): read **The Shape of the Hour** at step 6.
6. **Read** one interlude story: the Torn or Taken story from the loop's resolution if it applies; otherwise the story below that fits the loop just ended, with any sentence the loop's resolution adds. Then read **The Shape of the Hour** if Part II began at step 5, **Before the finale** the first time your log records The Way the Night Breaks, and any age story. On the Control token, click **Begin Next Loop**, then begin the next loop at **Loop Setup**. If **Age** or **Bank on-card Memory** has been skipped, the first click names what is outstanding and does not start the night; click **Begin Next Loop** again to start it anyway. When the night starts, the chat says how much Memory the cap removed.

After the Prologue and each of the first three loops.

You wake at First Dark certain that you have done this before. The others feel it too. No one in Ambergrove will believe you.

The Shape of the Hour (when Part II begins). The town has begun to notice that you notice. Somewhere past the edge of the Square, something that has been waiting politely decides to stop waiting. From the next loop, each district's second objective opens, the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.

After the fourth loop and every later loop. The night is the same. You are not. You catch yourself counting the hours in your sleep, and waking at eleven before the bell. The town is exactly as young as it was the first time. Every morning that never comes, you are a little older than it.

Age stories. The first time any investigator reaches a new age bracket, read its story aloud as well.

- **Weathered** (5 Years): *In a darkened shopfront there is a line beside your mouth that was not there when you came. The reflection notices it before you do.*
- **Elder** (10 Years): *The Town Hall steps seem higher than they used to. They are not. You count them each night, and each night it takes you longer to reach the top.*
- **Ancient** (15 Years): *A child in the Square takes your hand to help you down the Town Hall steps. You have known this child for every night you can remember. To them you are a kind old stranger, and always will be.*
- If an investigator **ages out** (18 Years): *They do not wake at First Dark. You find them on the Sunken Road, walking in the same direction as the others, hood up. They do not turn when you call their name.*
- If **no investigator can continue** (every investigator has aged out and no new investigator takes their place), the campaign ends here. Read: *Eleven o'clock comes, and no one is standing in the Square to feel it. The lanterns are lit, the band tunes up, and the night goes on without anyone left to remember it.* Do not read **The Last Hour** or the epilogue.

Before the finale (once your log records The Way the Night Breaks; if you begin the finale in the loop you first record it, read this first). You know the shape of the night now. You know what it costs to end it. Something has held this night in place all along, the way an anchor holds against the tide. The only question left is who pays. You may attempt **The Last Hour** during any loop from now on, or keep looping to prepare, knowing each loop costs years.

A fair warning, in the open: if the finale fails and you cannot offer the night enough, the campaign ends there. To keep a second attempt, enter the finale with at least **4 banked Memory per investigator** (12 at three) still in the pool. Banked Memory is the pool, not Memory on your cards. Some cards can take banked Memory away (Cass's weakness, The House Always Wins, is one), so bring a little extra.

The Districts

Read a district's entry the first time you enter it in a loop (The Square's during Loop Setup). Its objectives are printed on its act deck: act 1a (a surface objective) can be completed in either part, act 2a (a deep objective) only in Part II. When an act tells you to record something in your Campaign Log, do so at once. It lasts through every reset.

A district's act deck. Each placed district has its own current act. The Prologue, the finale and the first act deck laid out in a loop sit in the **Act** slot of the mythos mat; each further district's act deck sits in its own place in the row between the mythos mat and the map. When you Place a district's box:

- If your Campaign Log records its deep (act 2a) entry, remove its act deck from the game: its objectives are complete.
- Otherwise, if your log records its surface (act 1a) entry: in Part I, remove the act deck from the game. In Part II, remove act 1a from the game; then, if act 2a's requirements are met, act 2a becomes the district's current act (resolve its "When this act becomes the current act" ability now); if they are not, remove the act deck from the game.
- Otherwise, act 1a is the district's current act.

If act 1a would advance to an act 2a whose requirements are not met, remove the act deck from the game instead.

District resolutions. When a loop ends, after its loop resolution, read one resolution for **each district whose box you placed this loop** (always including The Square). Check each district's resolutions **top to bottom** and read the first that applies. They tell what the night did with what you found there; anything they describe was already recorded on the act's back when you completed it, so they add nothing further to the log unless they say so. If you defeated a district's Named enemy this loop, read the Named add-on in that district's Resolution 1 whichever of its resolutions you read. Read that add-on only once; if the chosen resolution tells you to read it instead of its story, follow that instruction.

Choices. The first time you complete a district's deep objective, its resolution asks the investigators to decide between two courses. Record the choice in your Campaign Log (**Choices**). Every choice echoes somewhere else in Ambergrove, and every one of them is waiting for you in **The Last Hour**.

The Lighthouse

The lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is dark. It has never, in any loop, been lit, and no one in Ambergrove can say why it was left dark. The stair winds up into the smell of old oil and older salt.

If your Campaign Log already records The Lamp Remembers, read this instead:

The beam you lit last time is gone, as if it had never been. The wick is dry again, the glass is cold, and the stair has forgotten your footsteps. But your hands have not forgotten the way up.

If your Campaign Log records The walkers keep their ring, add the following. This loop, after an investigator lights the lamp, exhaust each Echo in the Sunken Road district.

Far below, on the Sunken Road, the walkers have stopped. Every hood is turned toward the tower, waiting, as though someone once promised them a light.

If your Campaign Log records that an investigator signed the ninth line, add:

The keeper's book lies open on the shelf, and the ninth line is filled in a new hand. The ink is still wet, though the night has folded since.

If your Campaign Log records The ninth line was left blank, add:

The keeper's book lies open on the shelf, the ninth line still empty. Someone has drawn a careful stroke through it, as if to say: no one.

When you Place this box: The Lighthouse is reached only through the Sunken Road, so Place the Sunken Road's box too. The Lantern Room (revealed), The Winding Stair and The Keeper's Quarters join the map. Encounter set:  The Dark That Waits, Something on the Stair. Act deck: **Light the Lamp** (1a), then 2a in Part II. Set aside its story asset.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Ninth Line (you completed The Keeper's Ninth Death this loop)

You carry the logbook down with you, though you know it will be back on its shelf at eleven o'clock. Eight deaths, each dated tonight, each in the same careful hand. The ninth line is ruled and waiting. Whoever keeps this light has been dying for it a long time, and has been writing it down so that someone, someday, would read it.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias does not speak on the walk back. At the Square he stops, and says, to no one, "Eight. I thought it was more." Then he goes on.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Sign the ninth line.** One investigator writes their own name on the waiting line, so that whoever keeps this light next is someone who chose it. The book takes its due at once: that investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on their card). Record in your Campaign Log: *<that investigator> signed the ninth line.*
 - **Leave it blank.** Nobody else will be written into this book. Record in your Campaign Log: *The ninth line was left blank.*

Resolution 2 – A Light on the Water (you completed Light the Lamp this loop)

For the rest of the night the beam swept the water, and the town below seemed to hold its breath beneath it. Then the night folded, and the light went out with everything else. It does not matter. You have done it once. The lamp will remember being lit, the way a door remembers being opened.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias kept his hand on the lamp's brass until the last second. He still cannot remember why he left it dark. He is beginning to suspect that he was never given the chance.*

Resolution 3 – The Keeper's Round (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The stair is the same: the same smell of oil, the same cold glass, the same dark water. There is a kind of comfort in it now. Whatever the Lighthouse still has to tell you, it will keep until you come back for it.

- If your Campaign Log records The Keeper's Ninth Death, read this instead: *The stair is the same: the same smell of oil, the same cold glass, the same dark water. The keeper's book has nothing left to tell you. You climb anyway, out of habit, and the tower lets you.*

No Resolution – The Dark Keeps Its Lamp (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

The light stayed dark. The tower stands against the wrong sky like a finger raised for silence. Somewhere at the top of it, you are sure, something is waiting to be lit.

The Drowned Church

The bell tolled thirteen times at the first occultation. It should toll twelve. Water stands in the nave to the height of the pews, and the congregation is still kneeling in it.

If your Campaign Log already records The Thirteenth Toll, read this instead:

You count the strokes before they come. Twelve, and the pause, and the thirteenth. The congregation kneels in the black water exactly where it knelt before. None of them look up. The register in the Vestry has closed itself again.

If your Campaign Log records You have spoken the name, add:

The kneeling congregation is murmuring now, all of them, the same two syllables over and over under the black water. You know the word. You were the one who said it first.

If your Campaign Log records The name is kept unspoken, add:

When the bell strikes, you feel the name behind your teeth, and keep it there.

If your Campaign Log records The drowned heard the true hour, add:

The kneeling congregation counts with the bell now: twelve, and then they stop, though the bell does not.

When you Place this box: The Nave, The Belfry, The Vestry and The Flooded Crypt join the map. The Flooded Crypt enters play closed; its second act (2a) opens it, and it enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records that act's deep entry. Encounter set: ♣ The Drowned Choir, The Drowned Verger, Thirteen, Rising Water. Act deck: **Why Thirteen?** (1a), then 2a in Part II. Set aside its story assets. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district, set aside until the second act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Page Beneath the Water (you completed The Hour Was Wrong this loop)

You come up out of the crypt with the page held flat against your chest, water running out of your sleeves. One hour. The whole night hangs on one misprinted hour. When the loop folds, you feel it close differently, as though a crease at the edge of the night has been smoothed flat, and the road will hold.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, add: *Below the flooded steps the rope hangs slack. For the rest of the night, and only for the rest of the night, the bell did not ring at all.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine stood in the nave with her palm against the cold stone until the water rose. "I heard it," she says afterward. "The first night, here, and all my life before that, very far off. I heard it strike thirteen, and I reached for it."*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Carry the page to the Press.** Where the wrong hour was set, the right one can be set again. Record in your Campaign Log: *The true page reached the Press.* Standing rule, from the next loop on: group limit once per loop, moving between The Square and The Reading Room does not place doom.
 - **Read it to the drowned.** They have knelt in the water all night waiting for someone to tell them the hour. Record in your Campaign Log: *The drowned heard the true hour.*

Resolution 2 – Twelve Strokes and One (you completed Why Thirteen? this loop)

You close the register on the torn thirteenth stroke. Someone in this church knew the bell had rung wrong, and pressed so hard the nib went through. When the bell tolls the next hour, you listen to the thirteenth ring with new ears. It is not an echo. It is a count that does not end.

- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine does not look at the belfry for the rest of the night. When you ask why, she says only that she has heard that bell before, and not in this town.*

Resolution 3 – Kneeling Water (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The church kept its secrets tonight, and kept its congregation, kneeling and patient in the black water. You know more of it than they do. It is less comforting than it should be.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – Thirteen (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave with the bell still counting behind you. Twelve. Thirteen. You do not remember the moment you started counting along with it, under your breath, like a prayer you were taught as a child.

The Sunken Road

The road between the town and the shore. The same figures walk it every loop, in the same direction, hoods up, never arriving. Some of them turn to look at you now.

If your Campaign Log already records The Road Remembers, read this instead:

The walkers are already on the road when you reach it, as they always are, going the way they always go. You know the milestones by heart now, counting up toward the shore and down toward the town. One of the hooded figures slows, just slightly, as you pass.

If your Campaign Log records that an investigator signed the ninth line, add:

One of the walkers carries a book under their arm, bound in oilcloth like the keeper's log. As you pass, they turn it so you can see the spine. There is fresh ink on it.

If your Campaign Log records You carry the walker's ring, add:

The walkers part around you. One reaches for your hand, finds the ring, and lets go.

If your Campaign Log records You hold the ticket, add:

At the Turning the walkers glance at your pocket, where the ticket is, and step aside as if for a paying passenger.

If your Campaign Log records You refused the ticket, add:

One of the walkers holds out a hand as you pass, palm up, like a conductor waiting for a fare. Then the hand drops.

When you Place this box: The Milestones, The Low Bridge and The Turning join the map. Encounter set: **1** The Waiting Congregation, The Mile-Counter, The Bridge Remembers. Act deck: **Walk It Backward** (1a), then 2a in Part II. (Walk It Backward counts each investigator's discoveries separately; discoveries elsewhere or out of order do not count and do not reset your count.)

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Worn Smooth (you completed Who Walks Beside You this loop)

You cannot stop seeing the face beneath the hood, worn smooth as a step, and the ring on the hand that rose to stop you. When the night folds you look for them in the crowd at the Square, and do not find them. They are on the road. They are always on the road. You wonder, for the first time, how many loops it takes to wear a face away, and what a night like this needs to hold it in place.

- If "**Birdie**" Okonkwo is one of your investigators, add: *Birdie's compass swung toward the walker and held there, steady as north, until the night ended. She has not put it away since.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Take the ring.** The walker opens their hand and lets it go, as if it had been waiting a long time to be carried somewhere else. Record in your Campaign Log: *You carry the walker's ring.*
 - **Leave it with them.** It is the last thing they have that is theirs. Record in your Campaign Log: *The walkers keep their ring.*

Resolution 2 – Against the Walkers (you completed Walk It Backward this loop)

You walked the road backward, and the road let you. The walkers did not stop you; some of them, you are almost sure, stepped aside. Whatever this road is, it has learned your shape, and you have learned its. Once a night, you will not lose an hour on it.

- If "**Birdie**" Okonkwo is one of your investigators, add: *"I came in on this road," Birdie says. "The wrong night. I remember the milestones counting down." No one asks her what they were counting down to.*

Resolution 3 – Same Direction (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The walkers went the way they always go, and so did the night. Along the milestones, none of them arrived. None of them ever will, unless someone changes the road.

- If your Campaign Log records Who Walks Beside You, read this instead: *The walkers went the way they always go, and so did the night. You know one face among them now. It does not make the road any shorter.*

No Resolution – Hoods Up (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You never learned where the walkers are going. At the end of the night they were still walking, and so, you realize as the night folds, were you: the same direction, hood of darkness up, not quite arriving.

The Square

The hub of the night. The sheriff stands on the Town Hall steps giving the same speech to the same crowd. He has been dead since ten o'clock. No one has noticed but you.

If your Campaign Log already records The Sheriff Is Already Dead, read this instead:

The sheriff clears his throat on the Town Hall steps and begins the speech you know by heart. You mouth the words along with him. Down in the Well, you know exactly what he is.

If your Campaign Log records The town was warned, add:

Near the back of the crowd a woman in a green shawl is not watching the sheriff. She is watching you, frowning, the way you frown at a word on the tip of your tongue.

If your Campaign Log records The vote was torn out, add:

The applause at the end of the speech is ragged, as if some of the crowd no longer remember what they are agreeing to.

If your Campaign Log records The vote still stands, add:

The applause comes exactly on cue, every hand at once.

Every loop: the Square's box is placed in Loop Setup, so its locations (The Square and The Town Hall Steps revealed; The Well and The Records Office unrevealed), encounter set (⌚ The Crossing, The Band on the Steps, The Same Speech, The Crowd Turns) and act deck are always in play. Act deck: **The Sheriff Is Already Dead** (1a), then 2a in Part II. Its story asset is in the Square's set-aside stack. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district, set aside until the second act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Carried, Unanimous (you completed The Vote That Never Ends this loop)

Every name in Ambergrove, each in its own hand. You have walked past these people a hundred times: the baker, the band, the children on their fathers' shoulders. They signed. They wanted the door open, and they agreed to a price, and then they forgot. The applause for the sheriff's speech sounds different to you now. It sounds like a vote being taken again.

- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, add: *It did not fall like a man. It folded, and for a moment the Town Hall steps were empty. Then the speech began again, from a mouth that was only a sheriff's.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine ran a finger down every name in the ledger. Hers is not there. She is not relieved.*
- If your Campaign Log records *The town was warned*, add: *One name near the bottom has been struck through, fresh, the ink still wet. Somebody listened to you, once, and took their name back.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Tear out the page.** No debt the town cannot remember agreeing to should be collected. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote was torn out.*
 - **Leave the vote standing.** A promise, however foolish, is how this began. It may be how it ends. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote still stands.*

Resolution 2 – The Body in the Well (you completed The Sheriff Is Already Dead this loop)

You looked down the Well and saw him, and then looked up at the steps and saw him again, giving his speech to the lanterns. The town is not just repeating. Something is wearing it, the way a hand wears a glove. You spend the rest of the night studying faces and trying not to wonder which of them are still their own.

Resolution 3 – The Same Speech (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The speech ended the way it always ends, and the crowd answered it. You stood at the back and knew what they did not, and the knowing sat in you like a stone.

- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – Eleven O'Clock (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

The lanterns, the band, the sheriff on the steps. You passed through the Square as everyone passes through it tonight, and it let you go. At the end of the night you are back in it, as you always will be, until you learn what it is hiding.

The Fairground

The occultation fair, mid-celebration, forever. The wheel turns. The music never finishes its tune. The ticket-taker smiles at you the way he smiles at everyone, and counts you under his breath.

If your Campaign Log already records The Wheel Still Turns, read this instead:

The music starts the same bar it started last time and gets no further. The wheel is turning. You know how the town looks from the top of it now, and you know how still it is. The ticket-taker lifts his hat to you, as he always does, as if you were old friends.

If your Campaign Log records You kept the night to yourselves, add:

The ticket-taker catches your eye across the crowd and touches one finger to the side of his nose. A man who keeps a secret knows another who does.

If your Campaign Log records The vote was torn out, add:

Here and there in the crowd someone stops cheering mid-breath and looks around, as if they have forgotten what they came to celebrate.

If your Campaign Log records The vote still stands, add:

The crowd at the fair cheers on the same beat as the crowd in the Square, though neither can hear the other.

If your Campaign Log records You hold the ticket, add:

The ticket in your pocket is warm. The ticket-taker's eyes slide past you as if you had already paid.

When you Place this box: The Wheel, The Hall of Mirrors and The Ticket Booth join the map. Encounter set: ☼ The Barker, The Wheel's Turn, Your Reflection Lies. Act deck: **The Wheel Still Turns** (1a), then 2a in Part II. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district: shuffle it into the encounter deck with its encounter set; it spawns at **The Wheel** when drawn.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Fare (you completed The Ticket-Taker's Bargain this loop)

He named no price. He only told you there was one, and that you would know it when you could afford it. As the night folds you can still hear the fair music playing its one unfinished bar, and under it, very softly, the punch of a ticket.

- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, add: *The wheel stopped for the first time in a hundred years. It started again at eleven o'clock, as though nothing had happened. Something had.*
- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *He called Cass by name and asked after her debts. Cass has never told anyone in Ambergrove about her debts. She spends the rest of the night working out the odds on how he knew, and does not like any of them.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Take the ticket.** He holds it out between two fingers. It is warm, and blank, and it is yours. Record in your Campaign Log: *You hold the ticket.*
 - **Refuse it.** Whatever he is selling, you will find another way out. Record in your Campaign Log: *You refused the ticket.* Standing rule, from the next loop on: the first time a **Lost Hour** is drawn each loop, cancel its revelation effect. The fair's clock stops for you, once: you owe the fair no fare, and the night cannot charge you the hour.

Resolution 2 – The Whole Town at Once (you completed The Wheel Still Turns this loop)

From the top of the wheel you saw Ambergrove laid out like a hand of cards face up on the table: every street full, no one moving, the church, the road, the dark tower at the end of it. Some part of you has kept that view. You find you can call it up with your eyes closed.

- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *Cass counted the town from up there the way she counts a deck. "Somebody's dealing," she says afterward. "I just can't see the hand."*

Resolution 3 – One More Ride (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The fair went on without you, as it always does, and the tune got no further than it ever gets. The ticket-taker went on waiting. He did not seem disappointed. He seems to have all the time in the world.

- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – The Tune That Doesn't End (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

Lights, music, the wheel going round. You walked through the fair and it walked through you, and when the night folded you could still hear the tune, stopping, as it always stops, one note short of the end.

The Almanac House

Where the almanac was printed. Stacks of it still wait by the press, bound and dated, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. At the back, a study door that no key in Ambergrove fits.

If your Campaign Log already records What the Almanac Hid, read this instead:

The press has set the wrong hour again overnight, as if you had never touched it. The stacks are bound and waiting. But the study door at the back is not as closed as it was. You can feel it, the way you feel someone behind you in an empty room.

If your Campaign Log records The true page reached the Press, add the following.

The page you brought up out of the flooded crypt lies on the bed of the press, dry now, and the type beside it has been set in the right order. Someone has been working here in the loops you were not watching. They have propped the side door to the Square open with a wedge of type.

When you Place this box: The Reading Room, The Press and The Sealed Study join the map. The Sealed Study enters play closed; its second act (2a) opens it, and it enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records that act's deep entry. Encounter set: ■ The Compositor, The Page That Wasn't, Ink Runs Backward, The Study Door. Act deck: **What the Almanac Hid** (1a), then 2a in Part II. Set aside its story asset.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Written Once (you completed The Appointed's Name this loop)

You did not say it aloud. None of you did. But you carried it out of the Study all the same, and the night felt you carry it. For the rest of the loop the thing on the hill came on more slowly, like a guest who has heard their name called from inside the house and is no longer sure of their welcome.

- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *Ayako knows the language it is written in. She has spent her life trying to find someone who spoke it. She has found them.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine knows the name. She heard it once before, on the night she reached for the sky and something, very politely, reached back.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Speak the name.** Once, aloud, into the empty study, so that it knows you know. The night takes its price for that at once: each investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on each investigator card). Record in your Campaign Log: *You have spoken the name.*
 - **Keep it unspoken.** A name held back is a name you can still use. Record in your Campaign Log: *The name is kept unspoken.*

Resolution 2 – The Altered Hour (you completed What the Almanac Hid this loop)

For the rest of the night the reprinted pages lay warm on the press, with the struck hour left blank, and the sky above the Almanac House was almost ordinary. Almost. When the night folds, the press will set the changed hour again. But you know now that somebody changed it by hand, after the proofs were pulled. The changed proof cannot tell you what was there before.

- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *In the margin of the reprint, in a hand she recognizes as her own, is a translation note Ayako does not remember writing. It is one word. The word is "wait."*

Resolution 3 – Fresh Black Type (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The stacks were bound and dated. The press was set. There was still more to read, and at the back of the house the study kept whatever secrets it still had.

- If your Campaign Log records The Appointed's Name, read this instead: *The stacks were bound and dated. The press was set. The study at the back stands open, and there is nothing left in it that you did not carry out.*

No Resolution – Bound and Dated (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave the Almanac House with ink on your fingers and nothing in your hands. The stacks go on waiting by the press, bound and dated for tonight, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. Someone printed that hour. Someone wanted it believed.

Finale – The Last Hour

Only once your Campaign Log records The Way the Night Breaks. During any loop from then on, an investigator at **The Sealed Study** may begin the finale as a ⚡ ability during their turn. Or, when Hour IX is reached while your log records *The Way the Night Breaks*, you may begin the finale instead of ending the loop.

When to begin. Beginning the finale at Hour IX gives you the most time: the Hourglass goes back to Hour V (Setup, step 2). Beginning at Hour VII or VIII leaves the Hourglass where it is, with only an Hour or two before Hour IX ends the finale.

The finale and the loop. The finale is part of the loop in which it begins: damage, horror, cards in play, the Hourglass, Dissonance and every "once per loop" limit already used stay as they are. During the finale you may still Place a district's box before moving into it, as Loop Setup step 5 allows. When the finale ends, first claim Victory, then read the finale resolution, then fill in the **Finale Record** on your Campaign Log (the loop, banked Memory at the finale, the deep entries spent, the resolution and the Years paid). Memory still on cards does not count as banked Memory for Resolutions 1b, 5 and 6. After Resolution 5 the loop ends as usual: read each placed district's resolution (except one whose Resolution 1 you read before the finale), then **Between Loops**. Investigators defeated during the finale are still present for the finale resolution and the epilogue: they wake at dawn with the others. After Resolutions 1–4 (including 1b) the campaign ends and no reset Years are gained; for their conditions and the epilogue, an investigator's Years are their recorded Years plus their Years pending plus any Years the resolution gives.

Before the finale begins: if you completed a district's act 2a this loop, read that district's Resolution 1 now and make its choice (any Years it gives are gained now: click **Years pending**). Then read:

You have lived this night more times than you can hold. You know the ledger, the wrong sky, the name. You know what the town agreed to: an appointment made in ink and never kept.

You feel the loops in your body now. In the joints of your hands, in the gray at your temples, in the way the Town Hall steps seem steeper each night. The town has not aged a single night. You have aged all of them.

Out on the hill, the guest has stopped being polite. All that is left is to keep the appointment, and to decide what you are willing to spend.

Setup

1. Press **Place** on **The Last Hour** box. **Contest the Crossing** (only a name; it has nothing to do with district crossings) becomes the current act, in the act spot on the mythos mat. Set every district's act deck aside: no district objective can be completed during the finale. The box also lays out a face-down set-aside stack in the mythos area's lower corner. Take **The Uninvited** (an enemy) from it without looking at the other cards, and leave the rest face down until the guide sends you to them.
2. Advance the Appointed's Approach to **Arrived** (click **Appointed** on the Control token until it shows Arrived). If it is set aside, it manifests. Dissonance keeps its current value.

Begin Finale itself moves nothing, so set the Hourglass now by the Hour the finale began at:

- *At Hour IX:* put Hours IX, VIII, VII and VI back on the Hours deck in that order (Hour VI on top) and make Hour V the current agenda. No Hour resolves: right-click **Hour** four times. Hours VII and VIII resolve again when they are reached (Hour VIII raises Dissonance by 2 again); Hour VI does not stack.
- *At Hours V to VIII:* leave the Hourglass as it is. No Hour resolves again, and the Control token keeps its Hour.
- *Before Hour V:* advance the Hourglass to Hour V (a Skip: each Hour resolves; click **Hour** until the Control token shows Hour V).

Then spawn the set-aside **Uninvited** where the Appointed would manifest (see **The Appointed**).

3. On the Control token, click **Begin Finale**: the **Contest** counter appears at 0. Then apply each of these your Campaign Log records:
 - *You have spoken the name:* gain 1 contest progress. It already knows that you know.
 - *The drowned heard the true hour:* rewind the Hourglass by 1 Hour. Below the church, a congregation is keeping time for you.
 - *The true page reached the Press:* until the finale ends, the chaos bag holds 1 fewer Static token than its band calls for (never fewer than 0). Every almanac in town now carries the true hour, and the sky is a little less wrong. This does not stack with Hour VI's "1 fewer" (What the Almanac Hid): the bag never holds more than 1 fewer Static token than its band calls for.
 - *You refused the ticket:* the fair's clock stops for you once more. Cancel the revelation effect of the first Lost Hour drawn during the finale, even if one was canceled earlier this loop.

Contest progress. Gain 1 contest progress:

- each time an investigator succeeds at Hold Back;
- when the Uninvited is defeated (its card says so);
- each time a deep Knowledge entry is spent with the ➡ on Contest the Crossing. Each entry can be spent once per finale. Note it on the Finale Record; it stays recorded for every other purpose, including the resolutions. Read its line aloud when you spend it:
 - *The Keeper's Ninth Death:* "Eight times the keeper climbed the stair and died. You tell it there will not be a ninth."
 - *The Hour Was Wrong:* "You tell it the true hour. It has been keeping the wrong one."
 - *Who Walks Beside You:* "On the road behind you the walkers stop, and turn, and wait with you."
 - *The Vote That Never Ends:* "You read it the minutes. It knows them better than you, but it listens."
 - *The Ticket-Taker's Bargain:* "Far off, a ticket is punched. On the hill, something checks its fare."
 - *The Appointed's Name:* "You do not say it. You let it see that you could."

When contest progress reaches **6** (5 with one investigator, 7 with four), advance Contest the Crossing: the contest is reached. Every deep entry you carry into the finale is one step of it; the rest must be taken from the Appointed. During the finale, a Hold Back

success does not rewind the Hourglass (the Control token knows this). The finale also ends, with the contest **not** reached, when Hour IX is reached, when every investigator has been defeated, or when Dissonance reaches the reset value.

During the finale, if your log records:

- *You carry the walker's ring:* once during the finale, when an investigator takes the Hold Back action, they may resolve it without a skill test: push the Appointed's Approach back 1 stage, disengage and exhaust the Appointed. This counts as succeeding at Hold Back.
- *The name is kept unspoken:* once during the finale, when the Hourglass would advance for any reason, the investigators may speak the name to cancel that entire advance (remove all doom from the current Hour).

Halfway. The first time your contest progress reaches half its target, rounded up, read aloud: *Every clock in Ambergrove stops, then starts again, ticking backward. For one breath you are all the ages you have ever been at once: young and tired and old, standing on every step of every stair you ever climbed in this town. Then the moment passes, and the thing on the hill is closer, and so is the dawn.*

Do not read until the end of the finale.

An investigator is **present** if they took part in the finale, even if they were defeated during it. Years gained from a finale resolution never make an investigator age out, except where Resolution 4 says so.

When the finale ends, find where you stand:

- If the **contest was reached**, the night can be ended. **The investigators must decide how.** Choose **one** of Resolutions 1, 1b, 2, 3 or 4 whose condition you meet and read it. Resolution 4 is always available.
- If the **contest was not reached**, read Resolution 5 if banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator (12 at three investigators); otherwise read Resolution 6.

Then read **Epilogue — What the Years Took**.

Resolution 1 – Take Its Place (contest reached, and an Ancient investigator, or the investigator who signed the ninth line, is present)

Someone has to hold the night's crease closed from the inside. The one who has spent the most of themselves here knows it before anyone speaks. They take the lamp, or the pen, or simply each of your hands in turn, and they walk out onto the hill to meet the guest, and they do not come back down.

- The investigators choose one present investigator who is Ancient or who signed the ninth line. That investigator becomes the night's new anchor: kept behind, decades older, so that the loop ends for everyone else. Mark them **kept as anchor** on your Campaign Log.
- If your log records **Who Walks Beside You**, instead: the ones who walk the Sunken Road come up the hill and take the anchor's weight with you. At dawn the anchor walks out with the others, free and not kept, but **3 Years** older. If your log also records *The walkers keep their ring*, the walkers carry the anchor almost the whole way: **1 Year** older instead of 3.
- The town wakes for the first time in a hundred years. The campaign is over.

Resolution 1b – Let It In, On Your Terms (contest reached, your log records *The Ticket-Taker's Bargain* and You hold the ticket, and banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator, or 3 per investigator if you kept the night to yourselves)

He punches your ticket without looking. He has been expecting you for a very long time. The door opens, not the way the town opened it, begging, but the way you open a door to a guest you have decided to receive. It comes in. It sits down at the edge of the Square in the lantern light, and it is smaller than you feared, and it is very, very old.

- The door opens on your terms, not the town's, and the night finally ends.
- The fare is everything you carried: banked Memory drops to **0**, and each present investigator gains **2 Years**.
- Ambergrove wakes to a morning with one more guest in it. The campaign is over.

Resolution 2 – Close the Door (contest reached, and your log records *The vote still stands*)

You pay the price the town agreed to and never paid. It is paid in years, as every price here is. You feel them go, all at once, like stepping off a stair that is not there. When you look up the sky has an edge again, and the edge is the dawn.

- Each present investigator gains **3 Years** at once, and the door closes. If your log records *The town was warned*, Ambergrove remembers just enough to share the cost: **2 Years** each instead.
- The debt is paid, and the door stays shut. The campaign is over.

Resolution 3 – Break Through (contest reached, and your log records *The Keeper's Ninth Death*)

You go the way the keeper tried eight times, along the beam and out over the water, and this time no one falls. You force the night open, and every present investigator runs through before it can close. Behind you the Square, the band, the lanterns, the sheriff on his steps, all fold away like a stage set in the rain.

- Every present investigator escapes, and each gains **2 Years**: the night closes on your heels. The campaign is over.
- But the loop is only paused. Somewhere, some night, an almanac will be printed with the wrong hour again. Was it really ended?
- If your log records *The ninth line was left blank*, read this instead of the last point: *No one is written into the keeper's book. No one is owed. The loop has nothing left to hold, and it does not start again.*

Resolution 4 – Seal by Force (contest reached)

The door is sealed, but not closed. Someone has to lean against it until the dawn comes, and the dawn is a long way off.

- The investigators choose one present investigator. They age out holding the door shut. The campaign is over.
- If your log records *The vote was torn out*, no debt is owed behind that door, and it pushes back with nothing but its own weight. The chosen investigator holds it until morning and walks away **3 Years** older instead of aging out.

Resolution 5 – Next Time (contest not reached, banked Memory at least 4 per investigator)

The loop wins tonight. The guest keeps its appointment, and the night folds along its old crease. But you have carried so much of it now that the fold does not quite close over you. You wake at First Dark closer than ever, older than ever, and certain.

- The loop ends. Mark it **Closed at the Hour**, read each placed district's resolution (a district whose Resolution 1 you read before the finale reads nothing more), and proceed to **Between Loops**. You may attempt the finale again. At the next attempt, fill in the Finale Record again.
- Do not read the epilogue yet.

Resolution 6 – The Loop Wins (contest not reached, banked Memory below 4 per investigator)

The night takes you. The town keeps repeating, and somewhere on the Sunken Road, walking the same direction and never arriving, there are new faces beneath the hoods.

- The campaign ends. Do not read the epilogue.

Epilogue — What the Years Took. Unless you read Resolution 5 or 6, read one line for each investigator who is present at the end, was not kept as anchor and did not age out, matching their age bracket after the resolution's Years.

- **Prime:** *You leave Ambergrove as young as you came, and no one on the train believes how tired you are.*
- **Weathered:** *There is gray in your hair that was not there the night you arrived. You keep it. It is the only proof.*
- **Elder:** *Your hands shake a little now in the mornings. You spent years on one night, and you would spend them again.*
- **Ancient:** *The station master helps you down from the carriage and asks if you have family meeting you. You had family, once, a hundred years ago tonight.*
- An investigator **kept as anchor** has no epilogue. On clear nights in Ambergrove, the lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is lit.
- If **Seraphine Vale** has an epilogue line, also read the line for her thread on your Campaign Log:

- **Unheard:** *Seraphine never learns what answered her that night. Some evenings she lays out the cards and waits, and nothing reaches back.*
- **Suspected:** *Seraphine copies every name from the town's ledger into a notebook. Hers is not among them. She reads the list every night anyway, looking for the one that should have been hers.*
- **Known:** *Seraphine never speaks the name again. But she sets a second cup at the table each night, and some mornings it has been drunk.*

Appendix – Starting Decks

Suggestions only: build your own deck if you prefer. Each list is a legal **30-card starting deck** of level 0 cards, checked against the investigator's deckbuilding options, the 2-copy limit and any per-deck limits. The cards listed on the back of the investigator card and 1 random basic weakness are added as usual and do not count toward the 30. Every card is an official Arkham Horror: The Card Game card in SCED's player cards; if one is missing from your copy, swap it for another level 0 card of the same class and a similar cost.

Elias Warde (Guardian). *Guardian cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Survivor cards (level 0-2).* 2 Beat Cop, 2 First Aid, 2 Machete, 2 Medical Student, 2 Physical Training, 2 Survival Knife, 1 Improvised Shield, 2 "Get behind me!", 2 Dodge, 2 Evidence!, 1 Heroic Rescue, 2 Emergency Cache, 2 Improvised Weapon, 2 Scrounge for Supplies, 2 Vicious Blow, 2 Guts.

Dr. Ayako Sōma (Seeker). *Seeker cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Mystic cards (level 0-2).* 2 Art Student, 2 Dr. Milan Christopher — Professor of Entomology, 2 Hyperawareness, 2 Magnifying Glass, 2 Research Librarian, 2 Holy Rosary, 2 Burning the Midnight Oil, 2 Mind over Matter, 2 Working a Hunch, 1 Emergency Cache, 2 Read the Signs, 1 Ward of Protection, 2 Deduction, 1 Eureka!, 2 Guts, 2 Perception, 1 Unexpected Courage.

Cass Lindqvist (Rogue). *Rogue cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 cards of any other class (level 0).* 2 Burglary, 2 Lockpicks, 2 Pickpocketing, 2 Silver Tongue, 2 Stealth, 1 Sticky Fingers, 2 Holy Rosary, 1 Backstab, 2 Elusive, 2 Sneak Attack, 2 Sneak By, 2 Dodge, 2 Emergency Cache, 1 Ward of Protection, 2 Cunning, 1 Opportunist, 2 Guts.

"Birdie" Okonkwo (Survivor). *Survivor cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 other Guardian, Mystic, Rogue and/or Seeker cards (level 0-1).* 2 Dig Deep, 1 Hunter's Instinct, 2 Leather Coat, 2 Stray Cat, 1 Flashlight, 2 Knife, 2 Live and Learn, 2 "Look what I found!", 2 Lucky!, 2 Scrounge for Supplies, 2 Emergency Cache, 1 Dodge, 1 Elusive, 2 Working a Hunch, 2 Survival Instinct, 2 Take Heart, 2 Guts.

Seraphine Vale (Mystic). *Mystic cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Seeker cards (level 0-2).* 2 Arcane Studies, 1 Clarity of Mind, 2 Jim Culver — Haunted Musician, 2 Rite of Seeking, 2 Shrivelling, 2 Magnifying Glass, 2 Blinding Light, 1 Meditative Trance, 2 Ward of Protection, 2 Emergency Cache, 2 Working a Hunch, 2 Defiance, 2 Fearless, 2 Guts, 1 Perception, 2 Unexpected Courage, 1 Deduction.

Appendix – Encounter Deck Contents

You never need this with the boxes: **Place** builds every deck. Use it to build the decks by hand, or to check a box.

Set	Cards (copies)	Used in
☉ The Occultation	Lost Hour (3), Slippage (2)	Prologue, every loop
☞ Echoes of Ambergrove	The Waiting Congregation (2), The Drowned Choir (2), Familiar Face (1), The Lamplighter's Echo (1)	Prologue, every loop
† Strays of the Night	The Minute Hand (1)	Prologue, every loop
☹ Static	Wrong Turn (1), Stutter (1), Dead Air (1), The Loop Notices You (1)	Prologue, every loop
⌚ The Weight of Years	A Year in a Night (2), What You've Forgotten (2), Old Bones (1)	Prologue, every loop
🏠 The Appointed	The Appointed's Whisper (2)	every loop from Part II; The Appointed and The Appointed's Approach are set aside
District sets	as each district's entry lists (the Drowned Church's adds a third copy of The Drowned Choir, and the Sunken Road's a third copy of The Waiting Congregation)	when that district is placed

Every scenario card prints its set's symbol. A district's locations, acts and story assets print its district's symbol (☉ The Square, 🏠 The Lighthouse, 🏰 The Drowned Church, 🛤 The Sunken Road, 🌳 The Fairground, 📖 The Almanac House); the Hours, the Prologue's cards and the story cards print ☉; the Named print 🏠; The Last Hour's cards print 🏠.

The Prologue's deck is the first five sets (21 cards). A loop's deck is those five sets plus the Square's (25 cards), plus each placed district's set, plus the Whispers from Part II.

The Still Hour – Campaign Log

Fill in at each interlude. Everything on this sheet persists across resets.

Campaign started: _____ Difficulty: ☐ Easy ☐ Standard ☐ Hard ☐ Expert

Loop Counter

Completed loops

Scar next loop (= loops; max 4/4/6/8 at 1–4 inv.):

Investigators:

Current Part: ☐ I — Learning the Rules ☐ II — The Shape of the Hour ☐ The Last Hour available

Investigators

Investigator 1

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out Finale: _____

Investigator 2

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out Finale: _____

Investigator 3

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out Finale: _____

Investigator 4

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out Finale: _____

Banked Memory

Banked Memory

(cap 10 × investigators after spending; never below 0)

Spent this interlude

Spent on: _____

Campaign notes

The Knowledge Track

When the guide says to record an entry, tick its row (or write its name on the line). It lasts through every reset.

The first time you record an entry, each investigator gains banked Memory: 1 for a surface entry, 3 for a deep entry.

☐ Prologue	_____
☐ Lighthouse — surface	_____
☐ Lighthouse — deep	_____
☐ Church — surface	_____
☐ Church — deep	_____
☐ Sunken Road — surface	_____
☐ Sunken Road — deep	_____
☐ Square — surface	_____
☐ Square — deep	_____
☐ Fairground — surface	_____
☐ Fairground — deep	_____
☐ Almanac — surface	_____
☐ Almanac — deep	_____
☐ Assembled	_____

Surface entries recorded:



/ 6 · Part II: 3+ or Loop 3

Deep entries recorded:



/ 6

Victory

		claimed	Memory banked
Church — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
Square — Named (Victory 3)	_____	☐	☐
Fairground — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
Church — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Sunken Road — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Almanac — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Lighthouse — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Church — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Square — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Fairground — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Almanac — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐

Threads

Seraphine's thread:

☐ unheard ☐ suspected ☐ known

Those Who Left the Loop

Investigator

Fate

Loop

_____	☐ aged out	☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out	☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out	☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out	☐ kept as anchor	_____

Choices

Prologue ended: ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ No Resolution

Loops ended: Torn

☐

Taken

☐

Closed at the Hour

☐

Prologue

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Lighthouse

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Drowned Church

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

Standing rule (1st):

The Sunken Road

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

Standing rule (2nd):

The Square

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Fairground

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

Standing rule (2nd):

The Almanac House

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

Name (Lighthouse):

Finale Record

Attempted on loop: _____

Contest reached: ☐ yes ☐ no

Banked Memory:

☐

Resolution reached:

☐ R1 ☐ R1b ☐ R2 ☐ R3 ☐ R4 ☐ R5 ☐ R6

Deep entries spent this finale:

How the night ended:

Years paid at the end:

Campaign Notes
